

Users of Silverlight

16 million subscribers to the largest 25 US daily newspapers. Compare that to 14 million Netflix subscribers and 23 million Xbox live subscribers

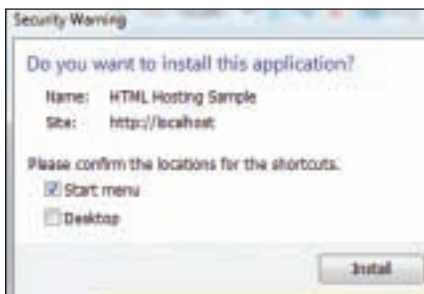
Silverlight mobile?

8.8 million - global iPhone sales in Q1 2010. 21.5 million - Nokia smartphone sales in Q1 2010. Nokia S60v5 already has a working Silverlight port

Developer corner

through a mechanism of OpenFileDialog (read) and SaveFileDialog (write). But come Silverlight 4, you have direct local file access to the users' "My" folders in their profile. These are things like Documents, Videos, Pictures, and Music folders under the user's profile. It lets you specify which folder you want to open by passing one of the Environment.SpecialFolder enumerator values to the Environment.GetFolderPath method. This method returns the path of the folder which can then be used to perform file operations, as shown in the code:

```
var sampleFile = @"sample.txt";
var path = Environment.GetFolderPath(Environment.SpecialFolder.MyPictures);
if (System.IO.File.Exists(path + sampleFile))
{
    System.IO.File.Delete(path + sampleFile);
}
StreamWriter sw = File.CreateText(path + sampleFile);
sw.WriteLine("<root>some data</root>");
sw.Close();
```



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Notification (aka "toast") API

One major flaw in these out-of-browser applications, in both Adobe Air and Silverlight was that there was no integrated support for Notifications; leave alone the ability to use the Windows's default notification tray to show messages like your IM client shows when you receive anything new. But Silverlight 4 tries to bring an end to that misery with a new API with the NotificationWindow method which acts like a subtle notification system with the ability to

temporarily display some information provided by the application on the user's screen. But one thing to remember is that Notifications can only be done in Silverlight out-of-browser applications. It is very simple to implement, however; Use the NotificationWindow method to provide a simple or customized notification mechanism for your application:

```
private void CustomNotificationButton_Click(object sender, RoutedEventArgs e)
{
    NotificationWindow notify = new NotificationWindow();
    notify.Width = 330;
    notify.Height = 75;
    TextBlock tb = new TextBlock();
    tb.Text = "Sample notification";
    tb.FontSize = 24;
    notify.Content = tb;
    notify.Show(3000);
}
```

Using Silverlight application as a drop target from your desktop

For a lot of scenarios, you may have wanted to be able to drag a file from your desktop or file explorer on to your Silverlight 3 or previous applications. You will be happy to know that Silverlight 4 now supports being a drop-target for the common drag-and-drop practice of clicking on a virtual object and dragging it to a different location or onto another virtual object. For this, the AllowDrop property of the UIElement must be set to true and its Visibility property must be set to Visibility.Visible for the UIElement to be a drop target.

Hosting Web Content within Silverlight Applications

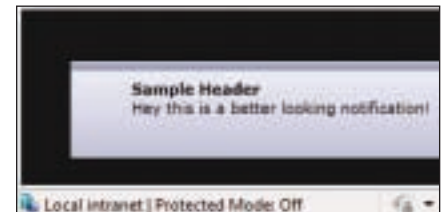
Enabling hosting HTML content in Silverlight is now possible by providing a simple WebBrowser control that will enable you to provide string-based HTML contents or navigate to a fully interactive URL

There are three ways to load web content inside of the WebBrowser control:

The NavigateToString method - The

NavigateToString method accepts a string that represents content (HTML and JavaScript). The content is passed to this method is rendered in the WebBrowser control.

The Navigate method - The Navigate method accepts a URI that points to the HTML content that you want to render. The URI does not need to be in the same



Different ways of notifying the user

Note

Silverlight cannot run on Linux (the Mono project has already ported Silverlight 3 for Linux and is on its way to release a beta build for Silverlight 4); but there is no doubt that the future of Silverlight rests in Windows and Windows alone. Also, we wish for an Android port soon!

domain as the Silverlight application.

The Source property - The Source property is another way to set the content to a URI.

The following code loads the www.microsoft.com Web page in the WebBrowser control when run Out-of-Browser.

```
wb.Navigate(new Uri("http://www.microsoft.com"));
```

You can even have a Silverlight 4 application hosting an embedded YouTube Flash video for that matter:

So that is Silverlight 4 for you guys. It sure has some nifty features and new toys to play around with. What matters is how you use them and create fantastic new applications with fresh UI's and tablet-specific features for the future, because the way we see it, Silverlight is destined to shine once Windows Phone 7 or Windows 7 tablets start rolling out in the market. Did we mention it has multi-touch support and full screen keyboard access on out-of-browser applications? 